

Phonograph

The invention that brought MUSIC to our ears

Early record players, known as phonographs,

were able to record and play sound back.
Thomas Edison struck
the first note.

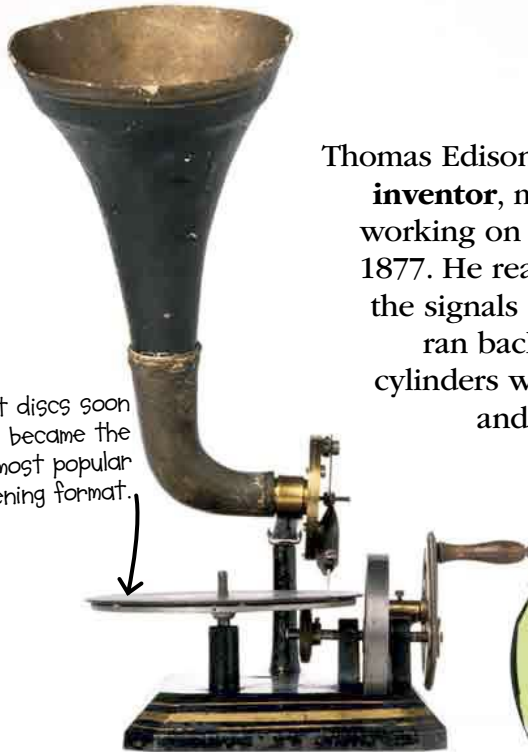


The horn is used to both record sound, and amplify sound when played back.

Sound signals

Thomas Edison, the famous American inventor, made an exciting discovery while working on a recorder for telegraph signals in 1877. He realized that the indentations made by the signals **PRODUCED SOUND** when a needle ran back over them. So he went to work using cylinders wrapped in tinfoil, a metal disc, a handle, and a needle, and invented the phonograph, the **first machine to record sound**.

Flat discs soon became the most popular listening format.



Did you know?

Thomas Edison thought that teaching would be a more popular use of his invention than listening to music.



Rotating cylinder plays sounds when the handle is turned.

Spinning discs

Edison's foil-wrapped cylinders were absolutely amazing, but they were a bit bulky, and could be played only a few times before decaying. In 1887, German-American inventor Emil Berliner invented a machine that traced sound grooves **onto a flat disc** instead of a cylinder. Many copies of the discs could be made—they were the **FIRST RECORDS**.

It paved the way for...



VINYL RECORDS became very popular in the middle of the 20th century and are still **MADE TODAY**.



The first **COMPACT AUDIO CASSETTES** were released in 1962, originally intended for dictation machines.